Montana Partner Guide — Working with Exos

For Montana Spaceport & Test Range: Edgar Johansson, Sean McClung, Isaiah Centifanto | October 1, 2026

1. Why this guide

Exos runs its programs inside Mission Control, our system of record, using an AI-native operating model we call exo3. As of today you each have your own sign-in to a Montana partner view. This guide covers how that works, answers the questions we expect on the Program Operating Agreement, and sets out how we think Montana and Exos can move fastest together.

2. How Exos works: the exo3 model in one page

- People set direction and make every commitment. Exo, our AI operations layer, does the tracking, drafting, routing and follow-up. Nothing contractual, financial, governmental or export-related is decided by AI. A named Exos officer decides and signs.
- Every workstream is a task with a named human owner. Every decision is recorded with who decided and when, and every action is logged. That audit trail is the point: it lets a small team run a licensed launch operation with large-company discipline.
- What it means for you: one place instead of scattered email threads. Post a note on the relevant task; Exo routes it to the Exos owner, and the answer comes back on the same task where all three of you can see it. Email still works. Mission Control is simply faster and keeps the record.
- Exos people (John, Neil, Phil, Lizi) send anything formal to you themselves. Our AI does not send commitments on its own.

3. Your Mission Control access

You will see: program status, partner documents (including this guide and the 'Fly with Exos → Fly from Montana' one-pager), a read-only list of Montana payload prospects, and the shared tasks below, each with notes you can read and add to. You will not see Exos-internal records. Access is logged and each account is individual, so please don't share sign-ins.

Sign-in: (1) open mc.exosaero.space and enter your montanaspaceport.com email. A one-time code arrives from noreply@notify.cloudflare.com (check spam). (2) Sign in with the temporary password John sends you separately. (3) Choose your own password (8+ characters). You land on the Montana partner view.

4. The shared task list

#	Workstream	Montana lead	Exos owner
3303	Welcome & Q&A (start here)	All	John Quinn
3304	Program Operating Agreement: path to signature	Edgar	John Quinn
3305	Task Order No. 1: site evaluation, candidate sites + site data	Sean / Isaiah	Neil Milburn
3306	Governor's signing agreement + delegation letters	Edgar	John Quinn
3307	FAA/DOT RFI FAA-2026-9736: aligned comments (due Oct 26)	Edgar / Isaiah	John Quinn
3308	Payload customer introductions	Edgar	Phil Eaton
3309	University & workforce program	Edgar	John Quinn
3310	Funding stack: federal grants + facility bonds	Edgar	John Quinn

Montana leads are our suggestion. Please reassign by posting a note on #3303.

5. Your Program Operating Agreement: questions & answers

What is Montana acquiring?

Two BLK3 reusable suborbital vehicles under the Exos National Charter Enterprise (NCE) program, on a build-operate-train-transfer model. Phase 1: BLK3.1 is built and flight-tested at Exos's current FAA-licensed site, with Montana's team trained in integration, ground operations and recovery as the build completes. Phase 2: BLK3.2, Montana-site licensing support, and a demonstration launch from Montana. Operations then transition to Montana, with Exos providing ongoing technical support under a wet-lease arrangement.

What does it cost, and when do we pay?

Phase amounts, payment timing and Task Order No. 1 terms are exactly as written in the agreement. Any change is agreed in writing with John Quinn. Ask clause-specific questions on task #3304.

Does the State of Montana have to appropriate money?

No. The agreement requires no state or municipal funding. The program is designed to be funded by federal grants and contracts, education partnerships, commercial launch revenue and private investment. Montana's role is to champion the program, help with federal applications, and provide the political framework for FAA site licensing. Task #3310 tracks the funding stack.

What starts the clock?

Signature plus the Phase 1 funding commitment is T0 and starts the vehicle build. Task Order No. 1, the Montana launch-site evaluation, starts on execution and runs 60 days: kickoff briefing (day 14), draft report (day 45), final ranked-site report plus a one-page congressional summary (day 60).

What's still open before signature?

From our side: your legal contracting entity and address (the draft shows 'TBD'), your authorized signatory and authority, the effective date, the Phase 1 funding path, and whether the Governor's signing agreement comes before signature or runs alongside it. Please post these on #3304.

Who holds which licenses?

BLK3 holds an active FAA reusable launch vehicle license under 14 CFR Part 431 (March 2026), and Exos is converting to Part 450, the current, site-flexible framework, ahead of 2027 flights. Flying from a new site in Montana is done under Part 450, which is the path we are already on. If Montana operates the spaceport site itself, that site needs an FAA launch site operator license (Part 420), and Exos provides the operator-side coordination package. The FAA gives real priority to sites with an active, licensed operator engaged. That is the leverage this partnership gives Montana.

What does a launch site need?

Very little fixed infrastructure. BLK3 takes off and lands vertically at the same pad, and Exos's mobile command module brings the rest. Neil Milburn's 9/18 'BLK3 Launch Site Basics' brief to Sean has the pad and hazard-area basics. Site-specific flight-safety analysis, including wind-driven impact dispersion and downrange population, is an Exos deliverable under Task Order No. 1. Site choice is the biggest single driver of the flight-safety systems a Montana launch requires, so good candidate data early matters most.

What technical information will we receive, and when?

BLK3 is U.S. export-controlled launch-vehicle technology. Detailed technical data and procedures are never shared through Mission Control or email. They are released only for program work (training, integration, operations), to U.S. persons, under an export-compliance plan Exos sets up with you before training begins. Please tell us early if any team member, university participant or partner is not a U.S. person, so we can plan for it rather than discover it later.

What can we say publicly, to customers or to legislators?

Accurate and simple: Exos is one of only three FAA-licensed reusable rocket launch providers in the United States and has flown commercial payloads since 2018 (SARGE). BLK3, its latest FAA-licensed vehicle, is preparing for flight. The Montana spaceport is planned and in development. Montana customers fly on BLK3 from Exos's current site in 2027, then from Montana once the site is licensed. Joint announcements and any statement naming Exos are cleared by John Quinn first.

How do payload customers work?

You make the introduction (task #3308). The Exos payload team scopes the payload and quotes the slot. Slots are sold, not donated. That revenue is what flies the vehicle. Universities typically fund through Space Grant, EPSCoR, or industry sponsors, and we help them find the path.

6. How to work with us most effectively

- Put it on the task. One question or update per note, on the task it belongs to. That is the fastest route to an answer and a decision, and all three of you see the same record.
- Name one Montana owner per workstream. Our suggestion: Edgar for agreement, state and federal relationships; Sean for site surveys and operations; Isaiah for site data, technology, and keeping Montana's records in step with ours.
- Make the agreement signature-ready now. Close the entity, signatory and funding-path items on #3304, and run the Governor's letter in parallel rather than in sequence. An executed agreement with a licensed operator is what federal grant reviewers and the FAA look for first.
- Feed site data early. Candidate sites with coordinates, land control, access, power and comms, nearby population and airspace constraints (#3305). Task Order No. 1 can only be as good as that data.

- Use the federal window. File Montana's site/range-viability comment on Docket FAA-2026-9736 before Oct 26. Exos files its operator comment separately, aligned but not joint (#3307).
- Stack the funding. Grants follow executed agreements and political support. Work the Governor's letter and delegation letters (#3306) alongside federal applications and facility bonds (#3310).
- Build the payload pipeline now. Every warm introduction from Montana that books a 2027 slot is a customer who later flies from Montana (#3308).
- Keep a short cadence. We suggest a 30-minute tag-up every two weeks, with the agenda pulled straight from the open notes on these tasks.

7. Exos contacts

- John Quinn, Cofounder & CEO: agreement, commercial terms, state/federal relationships. jquinn@exosaero.com, +1-972-740-8355
- Neil Milburn, Co-Founder & COO: site evaluation, FAA licensing, range and operations. nmilburn@exosaero.com
- Phil Eaton, Operations Manager: payload scoping and integration. peaton@exosaero.com
- Lizi Quinn: program coordination. lquinn@exosaero.com

Exos Aerospace Systems & Technologies, Inc. · 299 FM 1903, Greenville, TX 75402 · www.exosaero.com. This guide is a summary for convenience. The executed Program Operating Agreement governs.